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COMMUNITY ELECTIONS NEWS

York voters approve full slate of referendum questions

Voters approved additional ambulance funding, as well as bans on automated license plate reading cameras and single-use plastics.

Community: **York**

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York residents voted on six referendums Tuesday, including a special budget item.

Here's what happened to each of them, according to unofficial results from the town.

YORK AMBULANCE FUNDING

Following a monthslong struggle to find a solution for a significant shortfall in funding, York residents voted to approve a question that grants $500,000 to York Ambulance Association. A total of 7,096 people voted in favor, while 1,291 people voted against the funding.

The town will use $500,000 from its unassigned fund balance to sustain the service through the end of its contract with the town in July 2027. The service will initially receive $300,000 and will earn the rest in monthly installments so long as it can meet a set of conditions established by the town.

Officials say they will continue exploring the possibility of transitioning to an in-house EMS service instead of one that's contracted.

SINGLE-USE PLASTICS

Residents decided in a 5,921-2,287 vote to make permanent an ordinance banning single-use plastics.

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Restaurants and other establishments in York were already required to use earth-friendly or compostable stir sticks, straws and utensils. The ban, first adopted in May 2025, would have expired Dec. 31 because of a clause written into the ordinance.



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York voters could make a single-use plastic ban permanent in November

'STOP ALPRs' ORDINANCE

Residents also voted to ban automated license plate reading cameras, or ALPRs, in a 5,386-2,043 vote amid a nationwide debate over the ethics of similar technology.

The York Police Department **terminated its contract** with the ALPR company Flock Safety in September and removed at least four cameras on public property following a citizen petition that garnered 115 signatures.

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Tuesday's decision implements an ordinance permanently barring any public agency in town from using similar technology. It's already illegal for public entities to use the technology, per state law.

EMERGENCY MANAGEMENT, WIRELESS COMMUNICATIONS, REVENUE BONDS

Voters also approved an emergency management question that reorganizes disaster relief funds in a 6,896-1,127 vote.

An ordinance redefining requirements for mounting wireless communication antennae passed with 6,130 votes in favor and 1,511 votes against the ordinance.

Residents also considered a question created by citizen petition that would set new parameters for which projects could use general obligation funds and which could be funded by revenue bonds. A total of 3,962 people voted to approve the ordinance, while 3,579 people voted against it.

https://www.pressherald.com/2026/11/04/here-are-the-results-from-yorks-referendum-election